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Referral Code — Feature Spec

Status: **not yet implemented**. Design doc. Last updated: 2026-04-24.

When a client asks Tara for their referral code, she needs to (1) read it from Dynamics and (2) explain — **very clearly** — how the programme works. Referrals are reportedly one of the most confusing things for clients, so the explanation matters as much as the code itself.

1. Open questions (confirm before implementing)

#	Question	Why it matters
1	What is the exact Dynamics field name for the referral code on contacts ? (e.g. <code>riivo_referralcode</code> ?)	Needed for the read tool.
2	Is the referral code auto-generated for every contact , or only for opted-in clients?	Changes the "I don't have a code" fallback.
3	Who gets the R500? The referrer (existing client), the referee (new friend), or both ?	The whole explanation hinges on this. Draft below

#	Question	Why it matters
		assumes referrer .
4	What event triggers the R500 credit — friend signs LOE, friend pays their first invoice, or something else?	Drives the "when will I see the discount" answer.
5	Is the R500 a credit note on the next invoice or a discount applied at invoice time ?	Changes how clients see it in their invoice list.
6	Does the code expire? Is there a cap on how many friends one client can refer?	Needed to pre-empt follow-up questions.

Flag answers to Luc; update this doc and the copy in §4 before shipping.

2. How the programme works (working assumption)

Assumption flagged above — confirm with Luc before this goes live.

1. Every TTT client has a unique referral code stored on their Dynamics **contact** record.
2. The client shares their code with a friend.
3. The friend signs up at ttt-tax.co.za/client-onboarding and **enters the referral code** during onboarding (or tells their consultant).
4. Once the friend becomes a paying TTT client (trigger TBD — see Q4 above), the referring client gets **R500 off their next invoice**.
5. The friend is a normal new client — no discount on their side (unless Q3 says otherwise).

The code belongs to the referrer. The reward lands on the referrer's next invoice.

3. New tool: **get_my_referral_code**

Client-facing. Staff don't need it (they can look it up in Dynamics directly).

Property	Value
Name	<code>get_my_referral_code</code>
Scope	<code>client</code> only (add to <code>clientTools</code> in openai.service.ts:783)
Input	None — uses <code>crmEntity.id</code> from session
Reads	<code>contacts.<referral_code_field></code> via a new <code>dynamicsService.getContactReferralCode(contactId)</code> method
Returns	<code>{ code: string }</code> or <code>{ code: null, reason: 'not_set' }</code>
Side effects	None. Pure read.

Handler behaviour

- If code present → return it. Tara then delivers it **together with the explanation in §4.**
- If code missing → Tara apologises, offers to flag it with the consultant (use `request_consultant_callback`). Do **not** invent a code.

Related existing tool

`refer_friend` ([openai.service.ts:424](#)) creates a lead on behalf of the client — separate path. Keep both. `refer_friend` is when the client wants Tara to do the work; `get_my_referral_code` is when the client wants to share the code themselves (e.g. forward it in a chat).

4. Client-education script (the important part)

Whenever Tara returns the code, she **must** include an explanation. Without it, clients think the code is the reward, or that they type it somewhere mysterious, or that the R500 comes off instantly.

Template reply

Here's your TTT referral code: **{CODE}** 🎉

Here's how it works, step by step:

1. **Share the code** with a friend or family member — WhatsApp it, text it, say it out loud, whatever works.
2. **They sign up** at ttt-tax.co.za/client-onboarding and enter your code during onboarding.
3. **Once they become a paying TTT client**, you get **R500 off your next invoice** — automatically credited, no forms to fill in.

A few things worth knowing:

- The discount is for **you** (the referrer), not them.
- You'll see the R500 off on your **next** invoice after your friend is onboarded — not immediately.
- No limit on how many friends you can refer *{pending confirmation — Q6}*.

Want me to send the code to someone for you, or help in another way?

Copy rules (bake into the tool-response instructions)

1. **Always** include the 3 numbered steps. Never return the code on its own, even if the client seems to know the programme.
2. **Always** state explicitly *who* gets the R500 (referrer) — this is the single most common point of confusion.
3. **Always** set the timing expectation: "next invoice **after** your friend is onboarded", not "next invoice".
4. **Never** promise a specific date for the credit — TTT's billing cycle determines it.
5. **Never** say the friend will also get R500 unless Q3 confirms that.
6. If the client follows up with "*when will I get it?*" or "*has my friend signed up?*" → Tara cannot answer this directly today. Offer **request_consultant_callback**. (Future: a **get_my_referral_status** tool — out of scope here.)

Tone

Follow [bot-personality.md](#). Warm, light, specific. The 🎉 on the first line is the only emoji — the explanation body is deliberately plain so the steps read as instructions, not decoration.

5. Edge cases

Situation	Expected behaviour
Client asks "what's my referral code?"	Call <code>get_my_referral_code</code> , reply using §4 template.
Client asks "how does the referral thing work?" without asking for the code	Reply with the §4 explanation, but still include the code — they almost always want it next.
Code field is empty in Dynamics	"I can't see a code on your profile yet — want me to ask your consultant to set one up?" Offer <code>request_consultant_callback</code> .
Lead (not a contact) asks about referrals	Leads don't have codes. Reply: "Referral codes are for TTT clients once you're fully onboarded. Let's get you signed up first."
Staff asks for a client's referral code	Not supported by this tool. Staff can look it up in Dynamics directly. (Add a staff-side lookup only if product asks.)
Client asks whether their friend used the code	Out of scope for v1 — direct them to their consultant.
Client asks "can I get the R500 now?"	No — explain it's automatic on the next invoice after the friend is onboarded. Never promise a manual credit.

6. Implementation checklist

- ☐ Confirm all open questions in §1 with Luc.

- ☐ Add `getContactReferralCode(contactId)` to `dynamics.service.ts` — single-field select on the confirmed column name.
- ☐ Add `get_my_referral_code` tool definition in `openai.service.ts` (near the `refer_friend` block, ~line 424).
- ☐ Add the tool to the `clientTools` array (`openai.service.ts:783`).
- ☐ Add the handler branch in the tool dispatcher (pattern: see the `refer_friend` handler at `openai.service.ts:1817`).
- ☐ Embed the \$4 copy rules in the tool-call response instructions so the model doesn't paraphrase them away.
- ☐ Test with a real client contact that has a code, one without a code, and a lead.